

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Nietzsche requires both the death-of-God diagnosis and genealogy of morality.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

DCT, Euthyphro, Kantian autonomy, modified DCT, natural law, dharma/karma and non-theistic ethics are CORE ANSWER.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not reduce the topic to “religion teaches morality.” Do not merge justification with motivation or causal influence with logical dependence.

ANSWER LINE: [FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

02

Contemporary India anchor — constitutional morality and religious practice [SUPPORTING]

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Fact: Reporting on the 2026 Sabarimala review hearings describes the Supreme Court’s renewed examination of equality, religious freedom, essential religious practices and constitutional morality.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: The controversy illustrates the owner’s interaction thesis: morality may be shaped by religion, while public moral principles may also criticise religious practices.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

It does not by itself settle the philosophical question whether morality is grounded in religion.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

It does not by itself settle the philosophical question whether morality is grounded in religion.

ANSWER LINE: □ Fact: Reporting on the 2026 Sabarimala review hearings describes the Supreme Court’s renewed examination of equality, religious freedom, essential religious practices and constitutional morality.

03

Visual gateway — identify the relation before arguing

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Master verdict: Morality is not conceptually reducible to religion, but religion can supply motivation, formation and cosmic significance; morality in turn remains an indispensable internal and external critic of religious life.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (Recommended opening definition): The dependence view holds that morality requires religion for its authority, motivation or ultimate sanction, but these three claims must be assessed separately.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Master verdict: Morality is not conceptually reducible to religion, but religion can supply motivation, formation and cosmic significance; morality in turn remains an indispensable internal and external critic of religious life.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Master verdict: Morality is not conceptually reducible to religion, but religion can supply motivation, formation and cosmic significance; morality in turn remains an indispensable internal and external critic of religious life.

ANSWER LINE: Moral obligation can be grounded independently in reason, welfare, virtue, human dignity or the reduction of suffering, even when religion strengthens motivation.